

LEARNER GUIDE

Unit Standard Title: USE LANGUAGE AND COMMUNICATION IN
OCCUPATIONAL LEARNING PROGRAMS

Unit Standard No: 119467

Unit Standard Credits: 5

NQF Level: 3

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This material has been compiled based on the **UNIT STANDARD 119467: USE LANGUAGE AND COMMUNICATION IN OCUPATIONAL LEARNING PROGRAMS**

The program has been accredited by SASSETA in the Republic of South Africa.

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1. Introduction

This learning program is part of a complete qualification. For more details concerning the complete qualification please contact your service provider or alternatively the office of the SASSETA

2. Purpose of this learning program

The purpose of this unit standard is to facilitate learning and to ensure that learners are able to cope with learning in the context of learnerships, skills programs, and other learning programs. Many adult learners in the FET band have not been in a learning situation for a long time, and need learning and study strategies and skills to enable successful progression.

Learners competent at this level will be able to deal with learning materials, to access and use useful resources, to seek clarification and help when necessary, and apply a range of learning strategies. They do this with an understanding of the features and processes of the workplace and occupations to which their learning program refer.

- ♦ Access and use suitable learning resources Use learning strategies.
- ♦ Manage occupational learning program materials.
- ♦ Conduct basic research, analyse and present findings.
- ♦ Function in a team Reflect on how characteristics of the workplace and occupational context affect learning.

2.1 Target group

This program is compiled for the following **target group**:

- Security members
- South African Defense Force members
- South African Police Force members
- Correctional Services
- Individuals who wishes to complete the NQF level 3 National Certificate in security practices.

3. Standards and qualifications



It is important that you as the learner understand and realize that this training program is not presented in isolation, but that it was developed based upon nationally recognized standards known as unit standards.

Unit standards are the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).

Unit standards comprises of outcomes. An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention.

4. Assessments

In order to assess whether a learner can actually demonstrate the desired outcomes, assessment criteria are included in the unit standard. Each outcome has its own set of assessment criteria.

REMEMBER.....

The assessment criteria describe the evidence that is needed that will show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly.

Kindly refer to the unit standard attached hereto for the assessment criteria.

It is of utmost importance that the learner fully understands the assessment criteria as listed in the unit standard, as it is the only way in which the learner will know what he will be assessed against.

The **final or summative assessment** is the most important aspect of this training program. It is during this process that the learner will be declared competent or not yet competent.

The learner will know exactly how he will be assessed, and when and where he will be assessed. All of these details must be obtained from the training provider where the learner enrolled for his program.

5. Range statements

REMEMBER.....

Also included in the unit standard are the range statements in support of the assessment criteria.

The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

6. The learning guide

The learner guide is included in this material under various learning units. The learner guide has been designed in such a manner that the learner is guided in a logical way through the learning material and requirements of the unit standard.

On completion of this skill program, the learner will be assessed against the assessment criteria as stipulated in the unit standard.

Each of the modules consists of learner outcomes to be achieved during training and development interventions, work related experience or at your own time. The learner outcomes will enable you to achieve the required level of confidence and competence in order to undergo the summative (final evaluations) assessment.

The learner needs to assess his own knowledge and skill throughout the training process by completing the learner workbook. With the completion of the workbook you start collecting evidence to proof your competence. The learner workbook will be assessed (FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT)

TAKE NOTE

The learner guide will remain the property of the learner once the LEARNING PROGRAM has been completed.

TAKE NOTE

- The best results will be obtained if you start with Study Unit 1 in the Learner Guide, and work your way through it, study unit by study unit.
- All learning outcomes are vital and must be studied (and exercised for all practical requirements) thoroughly to ensure that enough evidence for all specific outcomes is generated.

7. Learning assumed to be in place

It is assumed that a learner which registers for this program have completed a program in communication at NQF Level 3 or equivalent.

It is imperative to understand that this program are only one of the building blocks to complete Skills program 1. The complete list of unit standards for Skills program appears on the next page.

7.1 Security program matrix

UNIT STANDARDS:

	ID	UNIT STANDARD TITLE	LEVEL	CREDITS
Core	244176	Use security equipment	Level 2	2
Core	114941	Apply knowledge of HIV/AIDS to a specific business sector and a workplace	Level 3	4
Core	244184	Apply legal aspects in a security environment	Level 3	8
Core	244177	Conduct a security patrol in an area of responsibility	Level 3	7
Core	117705	Demonstrate knowledge of the Firearms Control Act 2000 (Act No 60 of 2000) applicable to possessing a firearm	Level 3	3
Core	246694	Explain the requirements for becoming a security service provider	Level 3	4
Core	244182	Give evidence in court	Level 3	4
Core	244179	Handle complaints and problems	Level 3	6
Core	244181	Perform hand over and take over responsibilities	Level 3	2
Core	244189	Conduct access and egress control	Level 4	7
Core	242825	Conduct evacuations and emergency drills	Level 4	4
Core	11505	Identify, handle and defuse security related conflict	Level 4	12
Fundamental	119472	Accommodate audience and context needs in oral/signed communication	Level 3	5
Fundamental	9010	Demonstrate an understanding of the use of different number bases and measurement units and an awareness of error in the context of relevant calculations	Level 3	2
Fundamental	9013	Describe, apply, analyse and calculate shape and motion in 2- and 3-dimensional space in different contexts	Level 3	4
Fundamental	119457	Interpret and use information from texts	Level 3	5
Fundamental	9012	Investigate life and work related problems using data and probabilities	Level 3	5
Fundamental	119467	Use language and communication in occupational learning programmes	Level 3	5
Fundamental	7456	Use mathematics to investigate and monitor the financial aspects of personal, business and national issues	Level 3	5
Fundamental	119465	Write/present/sign texts for a range of communicative contexts	Level 3	5
Elective	117889	Demonstrate an understanding of Victim Empowerment	Level 2	6
Elective	12484	Perform basic fire fighting	Level 2	4
Elective	13912	Apply knowledge of self and team in order to develop a plan to enhance team performance	Level 3	5
Elective	244178	Apply neighbourhood watch principles	Level 3	5
Elective	113852	Apply occupational health, safety and environmental principles	Level 3	10
Elective	243188	Care for a service dog	Level 3	15
Elective	116534	Carry out basic first aid treatment in the workplace	Level 3	2

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Elective	113909	Coach a team member in order to enhance individual performance in work environment	Level 3	5
Elective	114942	Describe how to manage reactions arising from a traumatic event	Level 3	2
Elective	243190	Handle a trained service dog to deter crime	Level 3	8
Elective	119649	Handle and use a handgun	Level 3	2
Elective	119651	Handle and use a manually operated rifle or carbine	Level 3	2
Elective	119650	Handle and use a self-loading rifle or carbine	Level 3	2
Elective	119652	Handle and use a shotgun	Level 3	2
Elective	114979	Operate a computer workstation in a business environment	Level 3	2
Elective	244335	Conduct security at an event	Level 4	5
Elective	252174	Demonstrate an understanding of security measures within a port security environment	Level 4	4
Elective	246693	Explain the requirements for safeguarding a national key point	Level 4	4
Elective	123515	Handle and use a handgun for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	123519	Handle and use a manually operated rifle or carbine for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	123511	Handle and use a self loading rifle or carbine for business	Level 4	3
Elective	123514	Handle and use a shotgun for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	11985	Inspect, drive and maintain an official vehicle	Level 4	3
Elective	11513	Operate effectively within a specified control room environment	Level 4	15

8. Preparation of summative assessment

After you have worked through the **LEARNER GUIDE** and you are satisfied that all theoretical and practical requirements/ evidence, as stipulated by the UNIT STANDARD, can be met, you need to make your own necessary arrangements with the assessor and/or facilitator. The training establishment will then arrange a suitable date for you to attend your pre-assessment meeting and then arrange for a suitable date to complete the final assessment.

8.1 RPL assessment



The assessment of RPL learners will be conducted in the same way as for those of new learners. The assessment pack is exactly the same and will therefore be used for new learners as well as RPL Learners. It must however be noted that learners who are applying for RPL must provide proof of previous learning and subject related experience prior to the assessment.

This proof or evidence can be in the format of certified copies (certificates) of previous learning programs that have been attended.

All the evidence will be assessed and authenticated before a learner will be allowed to enroll for an RPL program.

9. Roles and responsibilities

9.1 Facilitator/instructor

- Prepare to facilitate.
- Transfer of knowledge and skills

9.2 The role of the assessor

- Plan for the assessment
- Prepare the learner for the assessment

9.3 The role of the Learner

- Prepare for assessment.
- Accept the responsibility of learning.
- Accept the responsibility to produce/deliver evidence.

STUDY UNIT 1

Access and use of available learning Resources

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Identify relevant learning resources.
- ♦ Use the correct learning resources effectively.
- ♦ Demonstrate skills to select the appropriate information and acknowledgement of resources.

1. Introduction

In the modern times we live in, we have access to a multitude of learning resources. What are learning resources? They are sources (the point or place from which something originates) of information from which one can learn.

The many different types of resources means that we need to have a goal (to know what we want/need), and also the ability to access/use the resources available to us.

2. Relevant learning resources are identified

IMPORTANT

It is very important that the learning resources you use are *relevant* to your goal (what you need/want to achieve). You need to know where to find the different learning resources:

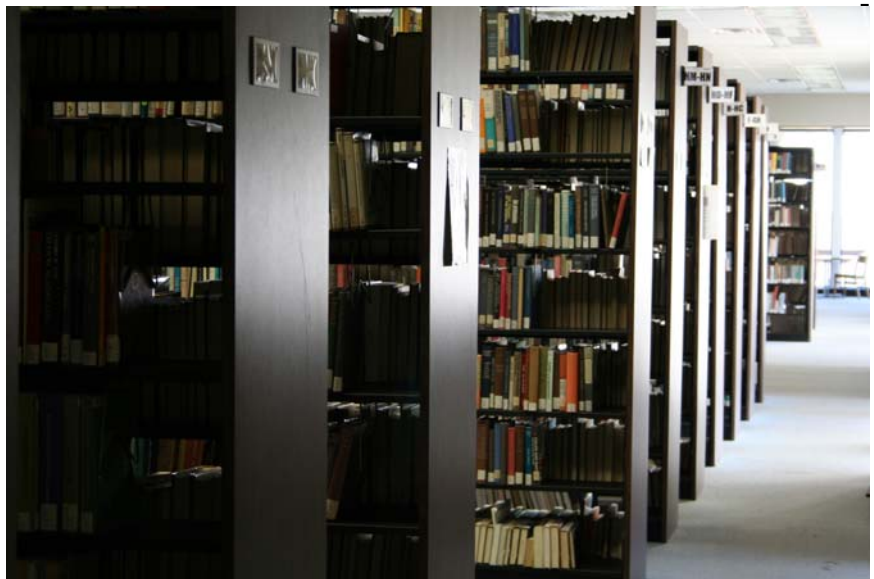
♦ Resource centres

MEANING

These are 'places' where you will find various types of learning resources,

EXAMPLE:

Libraries - where you will find mostly printed information, but also some visual information; internet - where you will find a wealth of electronic information; archives - where records (including data) are kept; etc.



TAKE NOTE

Once you have located the resource centre/s, you need to be able to identify the actual learning resources, so that you can select a relevant one:

♦ **General texts**

MEANING

These are usually in the form of books, but can also be reports, letters, memo's, etc.



♦ **Printed and visual media**

MEANING

Firstly, we need to know that media is the means of communication that reaches large numbers of people.

EXAMPLE:

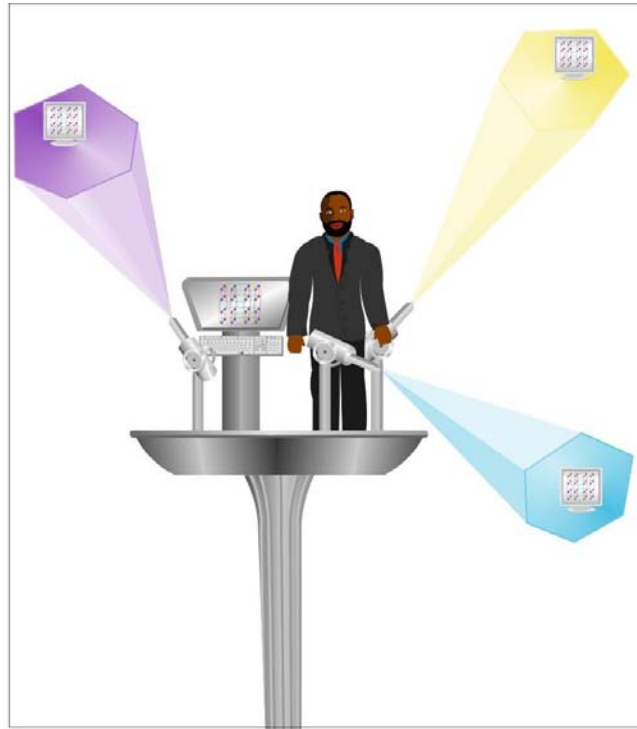
Printed media is mainly newspapers and magazines. Visual media is television and films/videos. We also have audio media - the radio - but this is not an ideal learning resource, because it is not easy to retain information that you have only heard.



♦ Internet

MEANING

This is becoming an increasingly valuable learning resource, as the sky is the limit regarding the information available on the internet. It is, however, of vital importance to know *exactly* what it is you need to find out/learn, as it is very easy to stray off the topic/subject due to the vast array of information.



♦ Other people



Here we have a learning resource that is often underestimated because of its simplicity. The most important factor regarding this resource, is that the person/people must be knowledgeable on the specific topic/subject. A wealth of information lies hidden within experienced people, who are often only too happy to share it with interested parties.

3. Use learning resources effectively through appropriate selection of information and acknowledgement of sources.

As mentioned earlier, before you can start using information to learn from, it is of great importance to know what your goal is - know what information you need to know.

Once you have identified what it is that you have to know, you need to be able to select information appropriately - you need to choose the correct information that will enable you to achieve your goal. Make sure you request or choose material that contains information that will satisfy your need. The choice of inappropriate information will only confuse you and make your goal so much more difficult to achieve.

After having used the selected material to gain the necessary information, it is of vital importance to cite/give credit to the sources you used. Failure to do so results in plagiarism. Plagiarism is the unauthorized use or close imitation of the language and thoughts of another author and the representation of them as one's own original work, and is punishable by law.

The acknowledgement of your sources should be in the form of a bibliography at the end of your communication. This credit also serves as proof that you have done research, which will in turn increase your credibility.

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 2

The use of strategies

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Define a summary.
- ♦ Summarise a text to use a strategy when using languages and communication skills.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills in the use of the following group activities.
 - ⇒ brainstorming
 - ⇒ group analysis
 - ⇒ peer and self-assessment mind maps
 - ⇒ note taking
 - ⇒ Memorising
 - ⇒ key words and
 - ⇒ underlining.
- ♦ Define a question.
- ♦ Know the reason for asking questions.
- ♦ Interprets and analyze texts.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills in reading techniques.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills in good listening skills.
- ♦ Explain a typical learning model.

1. Introduction

Now that you have the correct learning resources that contain the necessary information to help you achieve your goal, it is necessary to use the correct learning strategies to make this possible. Different situations require different strategies to help you extract the appropriate information. In this learning unit we will look at various strategies that will enable this.

2. Summaries

DEFINITION

A summary is a short version of a longer piece of writing.

- ♦ The summary should contain all the important parts of the original, but expresses them in a shorter space.
- ♦ Summarising is a very useful skill when gathering information.
- ♦ The summary should be written in your own words. It's more useful to re-write the contents, rather than copying out parts of the original.
- ♦ Read the original quickly, and try to understand its main subject.
- ♦ Then you will need to read it again to understand it in more detail.
- ♦ Underline or make a note of the main points. Use a highlighter if this helps. Look up any words or ideas you don't know. You need to understand the sentences and how they relate to each other.
- ♦ Work through the writing to spot the main sections or arguments. These might be shown as paragraphs.

REMEMBER.....

Remember that the purpose of a paragraph is that it deals with just one issue or topic. Draw up a list of the topics - or make a diagram. A simple picture of boxes or a spider diagram can often be helpful.

- ♦ Write a one or two-sentence version of each section. Just express the main point. Leave out any examples.
- ♦ Write a sentence which states the main idea of the original writing.
- ♦ Use this as the starting point. Then write a paragraph which combines all the points you have made.
- ♦ The final summary should capture the main point of the original.

REMEMBER.....

Remember that it should be in your own words. You re-create the meaning of the original in a way which makes sense for you.

EXAMPLE:**Original**

At a typical football match we are likely to see players committing deliberate fouls, often behind the referee's back. They might try to take a throw-in or a free kick from an incorrect but more advantageous position in defiance of the clearly stated rules of the game. They sometimes challenge the rulings of the referee or linesmen in an offensive way, which often deserves punishment or even sending off. No wonder this leads spectators to fight amongst themselves, damage stadiums, or take the law into their own hands by invading the pitch in the hope of affecting the outcome of the match. [100 words]

Summary

Unsporting behaviour by footballers may cause hooliganism among spectators. [9 words]

As can be seen, this strategy makes it possible to refer back to the information, without the cumbersome task of going through all the information that was gathered.

3. Group activities

Group activities are often very useful, because it looks at something from a much broader perspective than when it is the thoughts/ ideas/ bias/ short-sightedness/ etc. of just one person.

Here we will be looking at

- ♦ brainstorming
- ♦ group analysis
- ♦ peer and self-assessment mind maps
- ♦ note taking
- ♦ Memorising
- ♦ key words and
- ♦ underlining.

3.1 Brainstorming



Brainstorming is when different people who have a vested interest in the matter, get together and share thoughts and ideas on a specific topic. These thoughts and ideas should not be pre-meditated.

The following guidelines apply to ensure a successful session:

- ♦ write the objective - what you want to accomplish. Distribute it to the attendees, and post it for all to see during the session.
 - ♦ invite a mix of contributors/participants. Split large groups into teams to compete.
 - ♦ set a time limit :- 30 mins - 4 hrs
 - ♦ announce the objective and explain the rules :-
- ⇒ weird, wild, wacky and off-the-wall ideas are welcome -> negativity is not
- ⇒ build on ideas -> don't shoot them down
- ⇒ no interruptions from outside allowed (that includes cell phones!)
- ⇒ take a short break every hour
- ♦ capture all ideas as they flow from the group.
 - ♦ evaluate the ideas, selecting the best.
 - ♦ assign next steps.

3.2 Group analysis

Group analysis combines psychoanalytic insights with an understanding of social and interpersonal functioning. There is an interest, in group analysis, on the relationship between the individual group member and the rest of the group, resulting in a strengthening of both, and a better integration of the individual with his or her group.

Group members are supported, through shared experience and joint exploration within the group, in coming to a healthier understanding of their situation. Problems are seen at the level of the group, organisation or institutional system; not solely in the individual. Problems within are recast as obstacles without. The way in which the group functions is central to this.

Democracy and co-operation are the pillars through which group-mediated solutions to problems can flow in ways that are enduring. It is based on the principles developed by S.H. Foulkes in the 1940's and is rooted in psychoanalysis and the social sciences.

3.3 Peer and self-assessment mind maps

MEANING

Mind Mapping is a way of creating pictures that show ideas in the same way that they are represented in your brain.

Your brain uses words, pictures, numbers, logic, rhythm, color and special awareness to build up unique pictures of information. The ideas are linked together in a way that makes it easy to understand and remember.



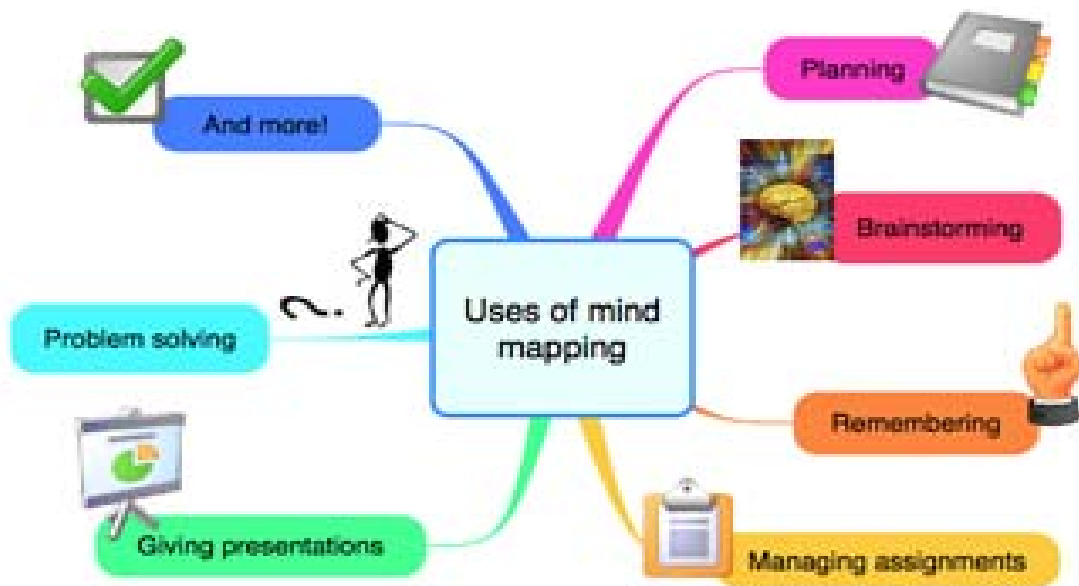
Mind Maps use exactly the same types of things to show the ideas and link them together. This is what makes Mind Mapping so powerful.

You start with a central topic that you are going to be examining, and add branches radiating from the center, and then sub-branches as required to represent your ideas.

You create your Mind Maps in a natural way by using your own words and connections that make sense to you. It is best to stick to one or two keywords on the branches and use the branches to show the connections between the ideas.

You can use Mind Maps for every part of your life where you need to:

- ♦ think more clearly; plan or organise things; solve problems; make
- ♦ decisions; remember things; do assignments; come up with new
- ♦ ideas or give presentations.



♦ Peer assessment

DEFINITION

Is where learners are involved in the assessment of the work of other learners. Learners must have a clear understanding of what they are to look for in their peers' work.

♦ Self assessment

DEFINITION

is a process where learners are involved in and are responsible for assessing their own piece of work. It encourages learners to become independent and can increase their motivation.

TAKE NOTE

The assessment gains more value if the learner can see (in picture form or basic key words), how they have done.

3.4 Note taking



Note taking is the practice of writing pieces of information, often in an informal or unstructured manner.

Notes are frequently written in notebooks, though any available piece of paper can suffice in many circumstances.

Unfortunately, it is often the case that while students are busy taking notes, they do not pay sufficient attention to what the facilitator is actually saying or explaining. This fact justifies the use of handouts printed in advance and given out to each student. The flip side of this is that notetaking makes learning "active learning" as opposed to "passive learning." When students have nothing to do but listen to the lecture, it is difficult for them to stay alert and attentive all of the time.

An easy solution to the problem is to figure out if you are an auditory learner. If you are, then it's probably better to listen and review with your textbook. If you are a visual learner, then the best would probably be a combination of listening and notetaking. If you learn by writing then you should focus more on notetaking.

Note taking from reading:

There are three main ways to take notes from written material.

- ♦ The first is direct quotation, in which the notetaker copies a passage verbatim (using exactly the same words) from the original text. Normally the copied passage should be enclosed in quotation marks.
- ♦ The second method is paraphrasing. This involves a rephrasing of the information in the reader's own words, indicating that he or she has read and comprehended the information enough to restate it.
- ♦ The third method is summarizing. Summarizing involves not just rephrasing the information but condensing it to the essential meaning.

3.5 Memorising

There are many situations where we need to memorise facts and information. These include learning a foreign language, revising for an examination, giving a speech, as well as remembering simpler things like people's names and bank card PIN numbers.

Fortunately there are many so-called mnemonic (memory aid) techniques available which can help us with these. You will probably be familiar with some of these techniques from your school days. For example, most of us are able to remember the colours of the rainbow by using a mnemonic such as.....

EXAMPLE:

'Richard of York gave battle in vain'. Here the initial letters of the seven words give us the colours: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo and violet.

This example demonstrates two elements of memorisation: imagination and association. Thus you create a sentence (imagination) using words starting with the initial letters of the colours (association).

Harry Lorayne says there are really only three fundamental learning skills:

- ♦ Locating the information you need.
- ♦ Remembering the information you locate.
- ♦ Understanding and organizing the information you've located and remembering, so you can apply it.

Memory works by association. In order for you to remember any new thing, it must be associated with something you already know or remember. As you learn and remember more, you give your memory more "hooks" to add further associations. By doing this, you will rapidly become a genius!

3.6 Key words

DEFINITION

A keyword is a word or concept with special significance, in particular any word used as the key to a code or used in a reference work, to link to other words or other information.

3.7 Underlining

An underline, also called an underscore, is one or more horizontal lines immediately below a portion of writing. Single, and occasionally double ("double-underscore") underlining was originally used in hand-written or typewritten documents to emphasise text.

When underlining text, it often helps you to understand/remember better, if you underline things that belong together in the same colour. If there are different things in the same text, use different colours.

4. Ask relevant questions

DEFINITION

'a form of words addressed to a person in order to elicit information or evoke a response'.

This means to direct words to a person in such a way, that they (hopefully!) respond with the information that you require.

4.1 Reasons for asking questions

- ♦ The most common use is **to get information**. If you need to find out something, the best way to do so is to ask a question. The most important factor here is, however, to ask the *correct person* the *correct question*.
- ♦ If someone has given you information, you might want to check with them that you **understood them correctly**, or alternatively, if the information was not conveyed clearly, **clarify the meaning** of what has been said. In both cases, it is obvious that the end result will not be the desired one if the wrong 'message' is acted upon.
- ♦ In conjunction with the above paragraph, it is necessary to **confirm the accuracy of the information**. Inaccurate information will lead to the same end result.
- ♦ Often **people are too afraid to ask a question**, in case they 'look stupid'! It must be remembered, however, that more often than not, there are other people in the group who would also like to ask the same question, but are too afraid/ embarrassed to do so.

REMEMBER.....

Remember: Rather ask a question and be a fool for five minutes, than not ask a question and be a fool for the rest of your life.

5. Texts are read/viewed for detail, interpreted and analyzed for a given context

When you read it is also for a purpose, even if the purpose is to pass time paging through a magazine. The difference between reading and listening to someone speaking to you is: when you read, you listen to the words someone is speaking to you on paper (written down), instead of listening to what they are saying to you in person. It is sometimes more difficult to interpret the written word, because you have to read for key words and key concepts. Purposeful preparation is very important if you want to give meaningful feedback.

- ♦ **First you plan:** You extract key words and key concepts by underlining them.

(Don't underline full sentences. Key words refer to the nouns and the verbs in the sentence). Read chapter or module titles, section headings, sub-headings and paragraphs for key words. Make use of reading skills and techniques. It may be necessary to read more than one reference to find all the information you may be looking for.

- ♦ **Then you prepare:** Take time to rearrange and restructure the key ideas (keywords and key concepts) into sentences. Extend these sentences into paragraphs that you organise into a logical sequence to make your feedback meaningful. *You have to rearrange the information you have gathered to make it your own, or to understand it.*

Now only can you present feedback, or respond either verbally or in writing, in the correct format. Meaningful feedback is prepared:

- ♦ It is planned – key information has been collected
- ♦ All the key issues are sequenced logically
- ♦ They are organized and well structured
- ♦ The final task is presented accurately, in the correct format.

6. Reading techniques

When you extract key issues from a written text, you are in fact planning your response. But *you must know your purpose for reading*. You are brainstorming or gathering information with a specific purpose in mind:



- ♦ to find specific information
- ♦ to gain an overview of a topic
- ♦ to express an opinion
- ♦ to give accurate feedback
- ♦ an interest in the topic
- ♦ to use the information in a different context
- ♦ to link and integrate information

6.1 Reading for pleasure: when you read something for fun or out of interest and curiosity. Without realising it you learn a great deal when you read for pleasure.

6.2 Scanning: when you are looking for specific information (a name; a date; etc.), or for an answer to a particular question. Let your eyes “run down” the page with only one thought or question in mind, the other facts are of less importance. Read headings and subheadings. Focus on the key concept or the specific information you are looking for.

6.3 Skimming: to form an overview or a rough idea of the material you have to read. Skim through pages asking yourself questions, encouraging yourself to read with a purpose in mind. Focus on creating visual images of what you are reading. Ignore all unnecessary details and examples and concentrate on the required facts.

- ♦ Take note of chapter headings, subheadings and the layout of pages, and decide whether it is necessary to read the whole chapter or only the relevant components.
- ♦ See if there is a summary at the end of the chapter. Read it first to create an initial mind picture of the contents of the chapter.
- ♦ Refer to the diagrams - if you are able to interpret them, you will have a better understanding of the text, and they will add detail to your initial mind picture.
- ♦ Read the first paragraph of each section or chapter, as it provides the clues or introduces the topics to be discussed. The first sentence of each paragraph usually introduces a topic or main idea. The conclusion is usually outlined in the last sentence of a paragraph, the last paragraph of a section and/or either the final chapter or last two chapters of a book.

6.4 Reading in detail: when information cannot be found during scanning or skimming, you have to read sentences and paragraphs more thoroughly. You make use of this technique when you are looking or reading for additional or supplementary information.

6.5 Reading critically: People are easily influenced by the opinions expressed by other people. It is important to remember that you are allowed to differ from the opinions of others. Perhaps your opinion is more acceptable and to the point. Thus it is important to be subjective when regarding the opinions of others.

Critical reading is also applicable when doing research on a specific topic. You will be required to read the findings and opinions of a number of people; you will not only learn from them, but you can add to their findings by expressing your own opinion.

A typical example of critical reading, is the newspaper or even a magazine, where a point of view is explicitly (directly and clearly) expressed, e.g. by one newspaper editorial only, or implicitly (indirectly) expressed, e.g. various newspapers that give different interpretations of the same topics/issues/principles. Newspapers give people's opinions. More than one paper per day means more than one opinion!

Distinguish between fact (cannot be argued or changed) and opinion (can be changed or influenced), and then express your own point of view on the topic. You cannot express your own opinion if you do not have a clear understanding of the topic being critically examined!

7. Spoken input is listened to for detail, interpreted and analysed for a given context**Good listening**

Nature gave man two ears but only one tongue, which is a gentle hint that he should listen more than he talks.

Throughout every day, you are continuously part of different situations where you have to respond to thoughts, opinions, ideas, statements, etc. It is important that in every situation you listen, and put yourself in the other persons' shoes before you respond. If you react impulsively, you could set up communication barriers, and interrupt the successful flow of communication.

7.1 The benefits of good listening are....

- ◆ Good listeners can make better decisions because they have more information.
- ◆ Good listeners save time because they learn more within a given period of time.
- ◆ Listening helps the communicators determine how well their messages are being received. Good listeners encourage and stimulate others into speaking.
- ◆ Good listening decreases misunderstanding.

Once again, it is of great importance to be aware of the speaker's possible bias, beliefs or incorrect/different perceptions, that could have a negative impact on the listener.

Biased information can lead the listener in a wrong direction, causing incorrect perceptions or understanding to be formed.

A biased speaker will lead the listener to extract a subjective implicit message, which is not necessarily the "truth", or "reality".

Beliefs indicate a person's subjective attitude toward something. As a result of a beliefs, a speaker has great control over the message that is conveyed. If he/she has a positive attitude about something and believes that it is the correct thing to do, the listener will receive a positive message, and will subsequently be affected in a positive way.

When difficult or controversial matters are addressed, it would be wise to look into the possible bias and/or beliefs of the speaker, before a conclusion or decision is formulated.

8. Learning takes place through communicating with others in groups or as individuals

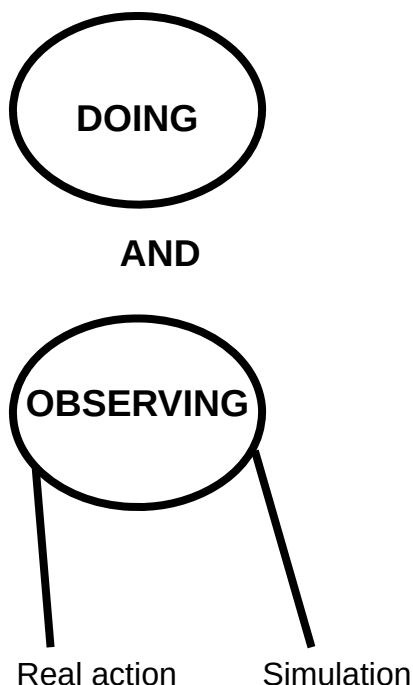
To learn means to gain knowledge of something, or to acquire skill in some art or practice. It also means to commit to memory (memorise). Learning is something we do our whole life - we continuously come across things we need to do/know that were previously unknown to us, thus forcing us to learn.

Learning can also be a conscious decision, taken to improve your academic/technical qualification.

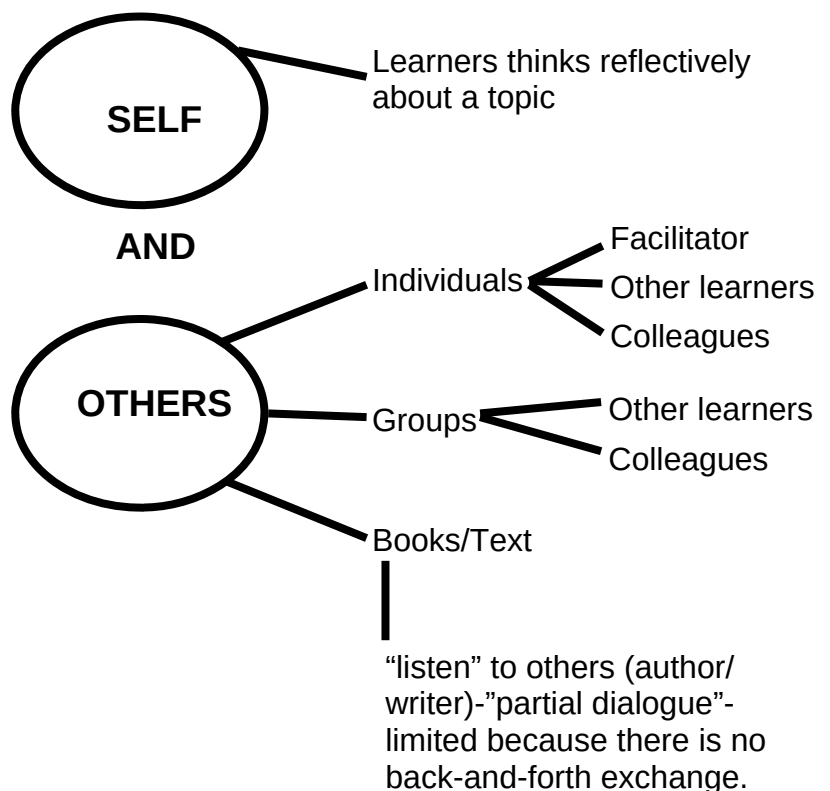
All learning does, however, take place in the same way. Let us look at a basic model:

Learning model

Experience of :



Dialogue with:



Let us look at the above model in detail:

You experience the 'doing' or 'observing' of what you want to learn. The observation could be of real (actual) action, or a simulation.

You enter into dialogue with:

- ♦ Yourself: By thinking reflectively about what you have 'done' or 'observed'.
- ♦ Others: Individuals - consisting of the facilitator; or other learners; or colleagues.
- ♦ Groups: Consisting of other learners or colleagues.
- ♦ Books/texts: By reading, you 'listen' to others (the author or writer of the book or text). This is, however, only 'partial dialogue', because no back-and-forth exchange takes place between you and those you are 'listening' to.

By communicating with others, be it individually or in groups, you are exposed to the opinions and perceptions of others, which often differ from your own, giving you the opportunity to change your mind. You are also able to confirm what you have learnt. Should you have misunderstood something, you can now correct it. It is a well-known fact that if your thoughts are verbalised (as they will be in a discussion with others), they tend to be remembered more easily.

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 3

Manage occupational learning materials

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Explain the various learning materials that can be used in an occupational environment.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills in layout and presentation of learning material.
- ♦

1. Introduction

DEFINITION

Occupational learning materials are learning materials that apply to that specific occupation/trade/profession.

They are very necessary when it comes to training or instructing the people working in that occupation, when trying to increase their proficiency levels.

IMPORTANT

It is, however, very important to use the vast array of learning materials appropriately - i.e. they must be managed correctly.

2. Organise occupational learning materials for efficient use

There is a wide range of learning materials available that make the training of workers less daunting than in the past. The learning materials at our disposal are:

- ♦ Texts
- ♦ Handouts
- ♦ text books
- ♦ Charts
- ♦ Maps
- ♦ Plans
- ♦ Diagrams
- ♦ videos/dvd's
- ♦ Internet
- ♦ models

2.1 Texts, handouts and textbooks

These are probably the most widely used learning materials, because they are easily accessible, more affordable, 'portable' and usually user-friendly. They must, however, be used correctly.

EXAMPLE:

It will be a futile exercise to use this learning material on illiterate workers, or where workers are trained on-site and have nowhere to put the books in order to read them or follow the facilitator.



It is also important that the content is appropriate - the correct information at the correct level for the worker.

2.2 Charts, maps plans, diagrams and models

It must be clear (easy to read/see) and also simple enough to understand, without losing importance. These are usually used to illustrate or explain a concept or an object. Once again, the circumstances must be conducive to using these, the end result will not be successful if they are used outside in the wind with nothing to hold them down.

2.3 Videos/Dvd's

These learning materials often succeed where others have failed. The reason for this is that most people learn best visually. Of great importance is that the videos/dvd's must be *current*, they must be of *good quality* (sound and picture clarity) and they must be *appropriate*. The equipment used to project the video/dvd must be of acceptable standard and in good working order. Lastly, the workers (recipients of the information) must be able to understand - must be on the same level as - the information.

2.4 Internet

This learning material is usually very current, but unfortunately, also very exclusive. In most companies/organizations the majority of the workers are not computer literate, or they do not have access to computers. The internet contains the most wonderful information, presented in the most amazing way, but if it is not accessible, it is worthless.

You have now seen how very important it is to organize your learning materials carefully and to use them efficiently, in order for learning to take place successfully.

3. Layout and presentation of learning materials are understood and used effectively

Most learning materials are set out and presented in an organised way, to assist the learner to extract the necessary information. It is important that the learner understands and uses the layout

- ♦ **Contents page:** This is the page at the beginning of the document/book that lists everything contained in chronological order - i.e. in the order it is presented. It also lists the page number on which it can be found. The contents page enables us to go straight to the necessary information, without having to page through the whole document/book.

This page also enables us to ascertain whether the information included is appropriate to our need/purpose. The contents page is very valuable when it comes to time management.

- ♦ **Glossaries:** This is an alphabetical list of terms particular to a field of knowledge, with explanations. It helps us to understand terms found in the text that are unfamiliar to us. Because those terms are specific to a topic/subject, they are often not found in the average dictionary. The glossary can be found at the back of the book/document, just before the index.
- ♦ **Index:** This is an alphabetical list of persons, subjects, etc., mentioned in a printed work/text, usually at the back, and indicating where they are referred to. This list helps us to go to the exact place in the text where what we are looking for, is located.
- ♦ **Electronic texts:** These are texts (written work/information) found on computers as email or internet websites. The layout and presentation of these texts differs greatly, for various reasons.

Firstly, because the information gets updated regularly, the contents page, glossary and index change continuously - this sometimes leads to writers disregarding those three items in favour of a more informal layout.

Secondly, the fierce competition amongst various websites results in many individual layouts and presentations, to attract the most attention. In order to extract the optimum information from an electronic text, a person has to be very familiar with the computer and its various functions.

4. **Technical language/terminology (jargon) is engaged with, and clarification sought if needed**

Technical language or terminology is specific to an occupation/trade/ profession, therefore you will come across it in your work. It is important that you familiarize yourself with it, as it will accelerate your progress and benefit you in the long run. The first place to seek clarification is in the glossary of the text you are dealing with. Alternatively, colleagues or your superiors should be able to assist you.

From the above information it is clear that it is vital to manage occupational learning materials well, in order to achieve your goals.

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 4

Basic research

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge of basic research terminology by defining the following terminology.
 - ⇒ Research
 - ⇒ Analyse
 - ⇒ Define
 - ⇒ Present
 - ⇒ Findings.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge of the basic research steps that needs to be followed.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills basic research techniques.
- ♦ Analyze research findings.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills to apply a typical oral presentation format.

1. Introduction

In order to complete this learning unit successfully, it is important to know the following definitions:



DEFINITION

- ♦ **Research:** Systematic investigation to establish facts or collect information on a subject.
- ♦ **Analyse:** To examine in detail and break down into components in order to discover meaning, essential features, etc.
- ♦ **Define:** To state precisely the meaning of words, terms, etc.
- ♦ **Present:** To submit for judgment or consideration
- ♦ **Findings:** The conclusions reached after analysis

2. Appropriate or relevant topic and scope is identified and defined

When conducting basic research, it is vital to identify a topic that covers the required area that will enable you to complete the task successfully.



EXAMPLE:

When researching the hosting of the Olympic Games, it will be meaningless to look into the education system of our country, but of great value to look into the types of accommodation that are available.

From there it will be necessary to define accommodation, in order to satisfy the needs of the target market.

3. Research steps are planned and sequenced appropriately

When starting with your research, it is very important to have a plan of what you need to do, otherwise you will end up with a mountain of information that confuses you and has very little value as to achieving your goal. It is also necessary to sequence the information so that it makes sense.

All this can only happen if your research steps are planned and sequenced:

3.1 Task Definition

- ♦ define the topic/problem
- ♦ identify the information requirements of the topic/problem

3.2 Information Seeking Strategies

- ♦ determine the range of possible sources
- ♦ evaluate the different possible sources to determine priorities

3.3 Location and Access

- ♦ locate sources
- ♦ find information within the sources

3.4 Use of Information

- ♦ engage (read, hear, view, touch) the information in the source
- ♦ extract information from a source

3.5 Synthesis: - Putting it all together

- ♦ organise information from multiple sources
- ♦ create a product or performance

3.6 Evaluation

- ♦ judge the product or performance
- ♦ judge the information-solving process

4. Research techniques are applied

The research techniques are how we go about gathering the necessary and appropriate information.

- ♦ **Reading/viewing:** You will have to physically read or view the sources you have located. Write down or photocopy the relevant information that you will be able to use in your final product or performance.
- ♦ **Interviewing:** A wealth of information is to be gained from other people. This can be done by interviewing them orally, or by having them complete questionnaires. In both cases, only use the relevant information acquired.
- ♦ **Observing:** There are times when you just have to see how things are done in order to get the necessary information. It is very important to make sure that who or what you are observing, is 'behaving' correctly/appropriately.
- ♦ **Using appropriate electronic sources:** As mentioned earlier, electronic texts are wonderful sources of a wide variety of information. It is, however, of great importance to select them carefully, making sure that the information contained is appropriate.

5. Information is evaluated for relevance

In order to evaluate the relevance of the information you have gathered, you need to ask questions.

You need to ask questions, that have as answers, the keywords used in the identification of the information requirements. If you have managed this successfully, then you can be sure that the information is relevant.

6. Information is classified, categorized and sorted

To classify is the act of distribution into groups, according to some common relations or attributes.

To categorise is to place into or assign to a category (a group, often named or numbered, to which items are assigned based on similarity or defined criteria).

To sort is to arrange according to class, type, etc.

Even though these three definitions are very similar and one wonders what the difference is, it will be of great value to classify, categorise and sort the information you have gathered.

When you classify the information, you take individual concepts and group them with other similar concepts.

When you categorise the information, you take those classified groups and put them into bigger groups that are named and numbered. This will assist you in your placement of the information in the correct sequence.

When you sort the information, you place the categories into the correct order or sequence.

After you have classified, categorised and sorted the information, it should make sense and be user-friendly, resulting in a good product, presentation or performance.

7. Research findings must be analyzed and presented in the appropriate format



Analyse: To examine in detail and break down into components in order to discover meaning, essential features, etc.

IMPORTANT

It is important to analyse the research information you have collected, in order for you to be certain that you are addressing the correct topic/problem. This can only happen if you understand the information.

Once the information has been analysed and you are sure that it is relevant to your presentation, you must present it in the appropriate format.

These are a few examples of presentation formats:

EXAMPLE:

- ♦ Advertisement
- ♦ Article
- ♦ Flip chart
- ♦ Poster
- ♦ Brochure
- ♦ Slide show (PowerPoint)
- ♦ Oral report/presentation - (discussed in detail below)

8. Oral Presentation Format

8.1 Preliminary analysis and planning of your oral presentation:

Questions to ask yourself:

- ♦ Why am I speaking on this subject (problem)?
- ♦ To whom am I speaking (lay person, executive, expert)?
- ♦ What does the listener (audience) want or need to know?
- ♦ Am I supposed to offer a solution to the problem?
- ♦ Do I expect the listener to take any action? If so, what action?
- ♦ Do I want questions, suggestions or comments from the audience?
- ♦ What is the purpose of my presentation?
 - ⇒ to communicate information?
 - ⇒ to motivate my audience to accept my conclusions and recommendations?
 - ⇒ to stimulate them to take action?

Gathering and organising information:

- ♦ Use card catalogues, indices, reference stations, etc.
- ♦ Read and take notes on relevant information
- ♦ Develop a working outline, group information by category
- ♦ Read more articles than you use

Composing the oral presentation:

- ◆ Introduction: states the idea of your presentation
 - ⇒ Capture the attention of your audience
 - * First few sentences must interest your listeners
 - * Humour - can help, but can also be dangerous
 - * Begin with a visual aid or sound effect
 - ⇒ Introduce subject of your report
 - * Clearly state objectives
 - ⇒ Establish your credibility for your conclusions and thesis
- ◆ Body: develops the idea
 - ⇒ Explain subject in detail to accomplish the objectives of your presentation
 - ⇒ Methods for developing the body
 - * Examples illustrating points (visuals)
 - * Repetition of the major points
 - * Statistics sparingly used, and projected as visuals
 - * Comparisons and contrasts to touch the experience of the audience
 - * State expert source of subject
- ◆ Conclusion: reinstates and reinforces the idea
 - ⇒ The last thing you say is as important as the first in which you gained your audience's attention
 - ⇒ Deliver the 'payload'
 - * Review the purpose (objectives) of your presentation
 - * Summarise and underscore (stress/reinforce) the main points
 - * Make a conclusion from those points
 - ⇒ Keep short and to the point
- ◆ Practicing the delivery:
 - ⇒ "Practice makes perfect"
 - ⇒ Rehearse as closely to the actual speech situation as possible.
 - * Practice standing up
 - * Practice holding your notes
 - * Practice using visual aids
 - * Practice in room that you're giving presentation in or imagine it
 - * Practice in front of friends, in tape recorder or in front of mirror
- ◆ Delivering the oral presentation:
 - ⇒ Breathing
 - * Take a big breath before you start, breathe often during presentation
 - ⇒ Pitch
 - * Voice inflection (change in tone, pitch and volume) makes presentation more interesting

-
- ⇒ Voice quality
 - * Resonance (amplification) adds richness to sound
 - ⇒ Intensity
 - * Be loud enough for everyone to hear, speak slightly louder than conversation
 - ⇒ Rate
 - * Speaking too fast or too slow will irritate and lose your audience
 - ⇒ Pause
 - * Pauses draw attention to important points and help in breathing
 - ⇒ Pronunciation
 - * Make sure you pronounce words correctly
 - ⇒ Enunciation
 - * Speak clearly, distinctly and precisely
 - ⇒ Body language
 - * Try to appear self-confident and relaxed
 - * Eye contact is very important
 - * Avoid distracting gestures: scratching, excessive walking, etc.
 - ⇒ Visual aids (see below)
 - ◆ Visual aids:
 - ⇒ Function
 - * Keep audience interested
 - * Present information in clear fashion
 - * Help audience retain information
 - ⇒ Types of visual aids
 - * Models
 - * Graphs
 - * Maps
 - * Charts
 - * Photos
 - * Drawings
 - * short printed passages
 - ⇒ Keep simple and readable
 - ⇒ Explain in detail



As can be seen from the above detailed format, it is very important to:

- ♦ Know what the exact purpose of the presentation is
- ♦ Know who you are presenting to
- ♦ How what you are going to say
- ♦ Know where you will be presenting
- ♦ Know what you will need for the presentation
- ♦ Know how much time you have - don't go over the time

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 5

Function in a team

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills to function within a team during the following situations.
 - ⇒ Meetings
 - ⇒ Site visits
 - ⇒ Excursions
 - ⇒ Discussions
 - ⇒ Activities
 - ⇒ Workshops
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge of the responsibilities in a team.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge and skills to deal with conflict within a team.

1. Introduction

In life, a good team has a better chance of getting to the top (achieving goals) than an individual has. It is therefore of great importance to be able to function well in a team (group). The aim of group work is to produce better (more effective, more detailed, more comprehensive) presentations and reports. This is achieved through the combined talents of group members, contributing knowledge and ideas.

One difficulty with group work is that you can't work as quickly as you can by yourself. Patience, communication skills and commitment are all required to make the most of the contributions of all group members. Thus, effective group work requires each member to focus on the process rather than just the product.

2. Active participation



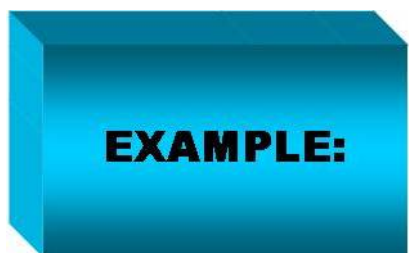
Active participation must take place in group learning situations

2.1 Meetings

In a meeting, two or more people come together for the purpose of discussing a (usually) predetermined topic, such as business or community event planning, often in a formal setting.

In organizations, meetings are an important vehicle for, and personal contact with, human communication.

The reason for holding a meeting will determine what kind of meeting will be necessary:



- ♦ **Status Meetings:** Generally Leader-led, which are about reporting by one-way communication;
- ♦ **Work Meetings:** Which produce a product or intangible result such as a decision
- ♦ **Staff meeting:** Typically a meeting between a manager and those that report to the manager (possibly indirectly).
- ♦ **Team meeting:** A meeting among colleagues working on various aspects of a team project.
- ♦ **Ad-hoc meeting:** A meeting called together for a special purpose
- ♦ **Management meeting:** A meeting among managers
- ♦ **Board meeting:** A meeting of the Board of directors of an organization
- ♦ **One to one meeting:** A meeting between two individuals

IMPORTANT

It is very important to make use of communication opportunities, especially as those afforded at meetings, should you need to make a point, clarify your understanding, share information, etc. In order to do this, you need to participate actively, i.e. you need to play a constructive role in the meeting. Not only will you be imparting information, but you should learn (from various people) as well.

2.2 Site/field visits

Site visits are planned and organised well in advance. They usually accommodate groups, to minimize disruption.

Site visits allow for:

- ♦ first hand experience (one of the best methods for learning)
 - ♦ observation
 - ♦ interaction
- } Two other very good methods for learning)

IMPORTANT

Once again, it is important to use the opportunities to learn, by participating actively while on the site/field visit.

2.3 Excursions**MEANING**

An excursion is a trip by a group of people, usually made for leisure or educational purposes.

It usually takes longer than a site/field visit, but is less interactive. It consists mainly of observation. Excursions are, however, valuable learning tools, because one learns from the views and observations of other people.

2.4 Discussions

A discussion is the examination of a matter in speech or writing. Here we are looking at a discussion in speech, more specifically a group discussion. As already stated, it is the examination of a matter, i.e. to investigate or discover facts about the matter. When this is done in a group, each member will give their own opinion and findings, thus disclosing varied points of view, from which one can learn. Active participation in the discussion is necessary for learning to take place.

2.5 Activities

This is the participation in specific tasks - often to practice a new skill or knowledge. When this is done in a group, it gives you the opportunity to differentiate between positive and negative outcomes, thus affording more learning opportunities, provided you participate actively.

2.6 Workshops

A workshop is a gathering or training session which may be one day (or part thereof) or several days in length. It emphasizes problem-solving, hands-on training, and requires the involvement of the participants. Often a symposium, lecture or meeting can become a workshop when it is accompanied by a practical demonstration. Once again, this is an ideal opportunity to learn from others, be it facilitators or peers.

3. Responsibilities in the team

As mentioned earlier, group work has its problems, one of them being unfair distribution of work and/or effort. It is therefore vital that all the members take turns and that the roles/responsibilities are rotated within the group.

It can be very frustrating in a group where one, or a few members, do all the work, leaving the rest as onlookers who do not get the opportunity to do their share. Equally frustrating is when one, or a few of the members, shirk their responsibility and choose to be 'passengers', leaving all the work to the rest of the group. In a test or examination situation all the group members receive the same marks, which ends up being very unfair.

The three main roles which need to be rotated are:

- ♦ **Conducting/chairing:** This person leads or controls the meeting or group work situation. This is a very important role, as it can determine the outcome.
- ♦ **Recording:** This is an important role for two main reasons. Firstly, the recording has to be correct, because it is often referred back to for various reasons. Secondly, it forces the recorder to listen and concentrate, understand and then reproduce the information.
- ♦ **Reporting:** The reporter has to be able to relay the message/information in such a way that the listeners get all the necessary details, without having everything repeated.



TAKE NOTE

.....
Taking turns and the rotation of the above roles gives everyone in the group equal learning opportunities.
.....

4. Conflict management and negotiating techniques

Conflict exists when there is a disagreement between two or more people because their perceptions of a situation are not the same. Many people feel that conflict must be avoided because it causes anger situations, but it does not only have negative or dysfunctional results. Conflict can also give rise to very positive or functional results. It is, however, very important that conflict is managed well in a defined context.

There is no one best way to deal with conflict. It depends on the current situation. Here are the major ways that people use to deal with conflict:

- ♦ **Avoid it:** Pretend it is not there or ignore it.
 - ⇒ Use it when it simply is not worth the effort to argue. Usually this approach tends to worsen the conflict over time.
- ♦ **Accommodate it:** Give in to others, sometimes to the extent that you compromise yourself.
 - ⇒ Use this approach very sparingly and infrequently, for example in situations when you know that you will have another, more useful, approach in the very near future. Usually this approach tends to worsen the conflict over time, and causes conflicts within yourself.
- ♦ **Competing:** Work to get your way, rather than clarifying and addressing the issue. Competitors love accommodators.
 - ⇒ Use when you have a very strong conviction about your position.
- ♦ **Compromising:** Mutual give-and-take.
 - ⇒ Use when the goal is to get past the issue and move on.
- ♦ **Collaborating:** Focus on working together.
 - ⇒ Use when the goal is to meet as many current needs as possible by using mutual resources. This approach sometimes raises new mutual needs.
Use when the goal is to cultivate ownership and commitment.

Closely linked to conflict, we find negotiations. Negotiations happen all the time in our lives. We all want our own way, but the person or people we are with also want their own way - so you negotiate. To get what you want, you always have to do something in return, or give up something.

"If I come shopping with you now, I'm watching soccer this afternoon." "If I work over Christmas, can I have Easter off?"

At work negotiations are sometimes more serious and are generally entered into with the specific intention of bringing about a change in a situation - e.g. negotiating for higher wages or different work conditions.

Both parties generally have a very strong reason for wanting the situation to change or to stay the same - depending on which side they are on.

The ideal result of negotiations should be a win-win situation, where although people have had to compromise, neither side feels that they have given up too much and gained too little.

To negotiate successfully requires equal amounts of skill, common sense and compromise.

Negotiations must be facilitated (led) by an unbiased chairman who does not stand to gain anything from the outcome. The chairman must be able to see all party's points of view and constantly seek the middle ground.

4.1 Guidelines that should make the negotiation process less stressful and more successful:

- ♦ Don't go into negotiations angry or aggressive. You will not be negotiating wisely and by antagonizing the other party/ies, you can actually do your own position harm.
- ♦ Know what you want to gain and what you are prepared to give up.
- ♦ Allow the other person to speak and listen to what they are saying. They too have their own needs and desires.
- ♦ Have a notebook with you so that you can write down points to remember. You might become so obsessed with having your say, that you will not be listening and could easily miss something important.
- ♦ If the negotiations are planned and everyone is given warning, prepare your case. The better prepared you are, the stronger your case will be. You will feel more in control and you will be more likely to get what you want. If necessary, seek advice from the experts.
- ♦ Depending on the situation, you might want to consult someone who knows the law or bookkeeping or whatever.
- ♦ Don't make accusations or be insulting.
- ♦ Don't lose your temper. If you lose your temper, you give the other party power over you.
- ♦ If several of you are involved in the negotiations, you must choose a spokesperson who will do most of the talking. If it is wage negotiations, it could be your union representative.
- ♦ Before the negotiations take place, you must all meet to make sure that you share the same vision and want to achieve the same goal. You have to place your trust in your spokesperson, so choose them wisely.

5. Teamwork results in a meaningful product or outcomes

All work is always done with a goal in mind. The purpose of the activities that get done is to achieve that initial goal. Often the goal is nearly achieved, but not quite. This results in frustration and often despondency.

More often than not, the negative situation could have been avoided. Two key factors are:

- ♦ **Reaching consensus:** To reach consensus means to reach general agreement (within the team). It is vital that the whole team is in agreement (even if negotiation has had to take place to bring it about), in order for the goal to be achieved. If there is no consensus, it means that the team members have different goals. If you do not agree with something, it is very difficult to give your commitment. This will ultimately sink the team as far as the original goal goes. Remember, a strong team is a united team!
- ♦ **Task completion:** In soccer we sometimes say a team can't 'finish', or their 'finishing skills' are poor, when they get the ball within shooting range of the goal posts, but fail to shoot a goal. The whole team has worked very hard, but they go away empty-handed.

So often a team works diligently and hard to achieve their goal, but right at the end it all falls flat, because a small detail or issue was left out. This can be the result of all the members of the team not reaching consensus. A team that is in agreement will be eager to achieve success, and will see to it that everything necessary is done in order to do so.

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STUDY UNIT 6

Characteristics of the workplace

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge of an industry by identifying a specific sector and organization type.
- ♦ Identify features of an occupational environment.
- ♦ Identify ways in which occupational environment features affect learning processes.

1. Introduction

Where you work (environment) and what type of work you do has an enormous influence on how receptive you are to learning. Some background knowledge on these obstacles can help you overcome them:

2. Sector and organisation type is identified

The economy of a country is divided into different parts called sectors. These sectors are made up of different types of organisations that all have the same focus area, i.e. they all do the same type of jobs or offer the same type of services. Let us look at some of the sector focuses:

♦ Services

The services sector of industry involves the provision of services to businesses as well as final consumers. Services may involve the transport, distribution and sale of goods from producer to a consumer as may happen in wholesaling and retailing, or may involve the provision of a service, such as in pest control or entertainment. However, the focus is on people interacting with people and serving the customer rather than transforming physical goods.

♦ Manufacturing

The manufacturing sector uses tools and labour to make things for use or sale. It ranges from handicraft to high tech, but is most commonly applied to industrial production, in which raw materials are transformed into finished goods on a large scale.

♦ Construction

The construction sector consists of the following areas:

- ⇒ infrastructure, repair and maintenance;
- ⇒ public and private housing;
- ⇒ non-residential public property (e.g. hospitals and schools);
- ⇒ industrial (e.g. factories and processing plant) and commercial construction.

♦ Farming

South Africa is divided into a number of farming regions according to climate, natural vegetation, soil type and farming practices. Agricultural activities range from intensive crop production and mixed farming in winter rainfall and high summer rainfall areas, to cattle ranching in the bushveld and sheep farming in more arid regions. These agricultural activities are:

- ⇒ **FIELD CROPS AND HORTICULTURE:** Grain and oilseeds, sugar, fruit, wine, vegetables, cotton, tobacco, tea and ornamental plants and cut flowers.
- ⇒ **LIVESTOCK FARMING:** Dairy farming, beef farming, sheep and goat farming, poultry and pig farming, game farming and aquaculture (mussels, trout, tilapia, catfish, oysters and waterblommetjies (Cape pondweed) are the major aquaculture species).

♦ Transport

The transport sector consists of the following areas:

- ⇒ Road transport
- ⇒ Rail transport
- ⇒ Air transport
- ⇒ Sea transport

♦ Mining

The mining sector involves all industries that extract raw materials (e.g. coal, ores, etc.) from the earth.

♦ Educational

This sector consists of:

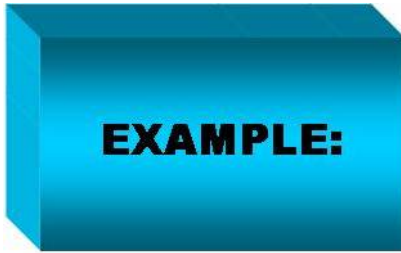
- ⇒ Schools (government and private)
- ⇒ Colleges
- ⇒ Universities
- ⇒ Training centres
- ⇒ Distance learning centres

♦ Government

The government sector is also called the public sector because it is representative of the public. It is made up of three smaller sectors:

- ⇒ **National Government:** National Government's responsibilities are everything to do with the whole country, e.g. defence, safety and security (police), health and welfare, finance, etc.
- ⇒ **Provincial Government:** Provincial Government's responsibilities are everything to do with the nine provinces, e.g. provincial roads, provincial safety and security, education, etc.
- ⇒ **Local Government:** Local Government's responsibilities are everything to do with the metro councils and municipalities, e.g. electricity supply, water supply, waste management, etc.

Within these various sectors, we find different types of organizations, e.g.:



- ♦ **Government organizations:** These organisations have only one shareholder - the government. Examples are: National Sporting Federations, Eskom, Nelson Mandela Children's Fund, etc.
- ♦ **Parastatal Organisations:** These organisations are partially state-owned. Examples are: Telkom, ACSA (Airports Company South Africa), etc.
- ♦ **Heavy/Light Industry:** These organisations are usually privately owned and listed on the stock exchange. Examples are: Mittal Steel, SASOL, PPC Cement, etc.
- ♦ **Large Organisations:** These organisations are privately owned and listed on the stock exchange. Examples are: Pick 'n Pay, Media24, etc.
- ♦ **Small Business:** These businesses are privately owned and seldom listed on the stock exchange. Examples are: Mr Video, your local butcher, your local spaza shop, etc.

3. Features of the occupational environment

The features of the occupational environment consist of everything that makes up that environment - physical and psychological.

The physical features are always the easiest to identify and discuss, because they are tangible (can be seen and touched).



- ♦ **Mining:** Large machinery and equipment, lots of dirt and residue, seldom spacious (inside the mine), etc.
- ♦ **Heavy industry:** Noisy, large machinery and equipment, sometimes exposed to weather conditions, often dirty, chemicals, etc.
- ♦ **Large organizations:** Sometimes hi-tech but impersonal, lots of goods being moved around, people traffic, etc.
- ♦ **Small business:** Limited resources, limited space, temporary labour, etc.

The psychological features are not always easy to identify because they are not tangible. The different perceptions of people also make psychological features difficult to generalise (they do not always apply to everyone).

EXAMPLE:

- ◆ Personality clashes
- ◆ Competitiveness
- ◆ Work
- ◆ Pressure, etc.

4. Ways in which occupational environment features affect learning processes and/or application of learning.

The environment in which one learns plays a very big role in how much learning actually takes place.

EXAMPLE:

- ◆ As an example, think of trying to learn in a factory, where the machines are making a lot of noise, the workers are shouting in order to be heard and a siren is sounding to signal that shutdown is five minutes away. There are so many distractions and obstacles that will prevent learning from taking place, even though the worker has the best intentions.
- ◆ Think of a worker trying to learn how to take stock during the annual stock-take. The environment will be a hive of activity, with noise and lots of movement interrupting his/her concentration. This situation will frustrate the 'teacher' as well as the 'learner', resulting in a negative experience for the worker.
- ◆ A final example is of workers attending a course at a training centre. There they get to sit at a desk in a quiet classroom and pay uninterrupted attention to the facilitator. Should they require assistance, it is available immediately.

[illegible]

WORDS/ACRONYMS	EXPLANATION OF ACRONYMS
ASSESSMENT	“A structured process of gathering evidence and making judgments about an individual’s performance in relation to registered national standards and qualifications”
ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	It describe the evidence that is needed to show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly. A list of evidence to be supplied by the candidate as proof of his / her ability to integrate all of the competencies listed earlier in the standard.
COMPETENCE	Competence is the ability to do certain things in a range of different environments with knowledge and understanding about what is being done and the effect this has on others. It includes <u>Knowledge, skills, attitudes, values and ethics.</u>
CREDIT	Each unit standard is worth a number of credits which gives an indication of the size and scope of the unit standard, the standard is worth. (1 credit = 10 notional hours of learning)
CRITICAL CROSSFIELD OUTCOMES	critical cross field outcomes is to direct educational activities towards development of the learners within a social and economic environment.
EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE	Body of theory essential for understanding and applying the standard. Principles, methods and techniques that would underpin good practice of this unit standard.
EVIDENCE	Evidence is a set of information or observations that provides proof of the learner’s competence.
FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Aims to assist the learner to identify any knowledge/skills gaps when demonstrating his/her current competence. Diagnostic assessment supports learning and progress of the learner.
INTEGRATED ASSESSMENT	Integrated assessment refers to: • assessing a number of outcomes together • assessing a number of assessment criteria together • assessing a number of unit standards together • using a combination of assessment methods and instruments for an outcome/s • collecting naturally occurring evidence in the workplace • Acquiring evidence from other sources such as supervisor’s reports, testimonials, portfolio of work previously done, logbooks, journals etc.
LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE	Building blocks (knowledge, skill and understanding) assumed to be in place
LEARNING PROGRAM	A “learning program is a set of learning activities in which the learner will be involved in working towards the achievement of one or more outcomes.
LEVEL	Each unit standard is registered on the NQF at a particular level based on the complexity of the outcomes and stringency of the standards.
NQF	National Qualifications Framework
RANGE STATEMENTS	The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

RE-ASSESSMENT	• The same method and instrument may be used, but, the task and materials should be different • The task and materials should, however, be of the same complexity and level as the previous ones. • In case the methods and instruments are changed it must be ensured that they are appropriate for the outcomes specified.
RPL ASSESSMENT	RPL is a way of recognizing what individuals already know and can do. The basic premise underlying it is that people, especially mature adults, learn many things inside and outside the formal structures of education and training and that irrespective of where, how and when learning was acquired, subject to assessment, it can be worthy of recognition and credit.
RPL	Recognition of prior learning
SASSETA	Safety & security sector education and training authority.
SAQA	SOUTH AFRICAN QUALIFICATION AUTHORITY
SPECIFIC OUTCOMES	An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention. Key performance areas in the standard are given, the focus is <i>not</i> only on current competence, but also on future competence in this standard.
SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Assessment used to record the level of competence achieved by a learner over a period of time, e.g. at the end of a program, term or year.
QUALIFICATIONS	Represent a planned combination of learning outcomes which has a defined purpose and intended to provide learners with applied competence and a basis for further learning
UNIT STANDARDS	the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF). “A statement of the outcomes that the learner must achieve to earn credit. Standards are nationally agreed and internationally comparable.”

Use language and communication in occupational learning programmes

SAQA US ID		UNIT STANDARD TITLE	
119467		Use language and communication in occupational learning programmes	
ORIGINATOR		REGISTERING PROVIDER	
SGB GET/FET Language and Communication			
FIELD		SUBFIELD	
Field 04 - Communication Studies and Language		Language	
ABET BAND	UNIT STANDARD TYPE	NQF LEVEL	CREDITS
Undefined	Regular-Fundamental	Level 3	5
REGISTRATION STATUS	REGISTRATION START DATE	REGISTRATION END DATE	SAQA DECISION NUMBER
Registered	2006-02-09	2009-02-09	SAQA 0264/06
LAST DATE FOR ENROLMENT		LAST DATE FOR ACHIEVEMENT	
2010-02-09		2013-02-09	

This unit standard replaces:

US ID	Unit Standard Title	NQF Level	Credits	Replacement Status
8973	Use language and communication in occupational learning programmes	Level 3	5	Complete

PURPOSE OF THE UNIT STANDARD

The purpose of this unit standard is to facilitate learning and to ensure that learners are able to cope with learning in the context of learnerships, skills programmes, and other learning programmes. Many adult learners in the FET band have not been in a learning situation for a long time, and need learning and study strategies and skills to enable successful progression.

Learners competent at this level will be able to deal with learning materials, to access and use useful resources, to seek clarification and help when necessary, and apply a range of learning strategies. They do this with an understanding of the features and processes of the workplace and occupations to which their learning programme refers.

- Access and use suitable learning resources
- Use learning strategies
- Manage occupational learning programme materials
- Conduct basic research, analyse and present findings
- Function in a team
- Reflect on how characteristics of the workplace and occupational context affect learning

LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE AND RECOGNITION OF PRIOR LEARNING

The credit calculation is based on the assumption that learners are already competent in terms of the full spectrum of language knowledge and communication skills laid down in the Revised National Curriculum Statements and unit standards up to NQF level 2.

UNIT STANDARD RANGE

Learning materials appropriate to the learners in a given context.

The complexity of the texts in the learning programme are appropriate to the levels of the learning programme, which will in turn influence the application of this unit standard.

Specific range statements are provided in the body of the unit standard where they apply to particular outcomes or assessment criteria.

Specific Outcomes and Assessment Criteria:**SPECIFIC OUTCOME 1**

Access and use available learning resources.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Relevant learning resources are identified.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Resource centres, general texts, printed and visual media, internet, other people.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Learning resources are used effectively through appropriate selection of information and acknowledgement of sources.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 2

Use learning strategies.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Information is summarised and used for learning purposes.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Specific techniques are selected and applied appropriately.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Group activities such as brainstorming, group analysis, peer and self-assessment mind maps, note taking, memorising, key words, underlining, skimming and scanning.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Relevant questions are asked.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Checking understanding, clarifying meaning, getting information, confirming accuracy of information.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Texts are read/viewed for detail, interpreted and analysed for a given context.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 5

Spoken/signed input is listened to/viewed for detail, interpreted and analysed for a given context.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 6

Learning takes place through communicating with others in groups or as individuals.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Facilitators, other learners, colleagues.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 3

Manage occupational learning materials.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Occupational learning materials are organized for efficient use.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Videos, internet, texts, handouts, text books, charts, maps, plans, diagrams.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Layout and presentation of learning materials are understood and used effectively.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Index, contents page, glossaries, electronic texts.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Technical language/ terminology is engaged with, and clarification sought if needed.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 4

Conduct basic research and analyse and present findings.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Appropriate or relevant topic and scope is identified and defined.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Research steps are planned and sequenced appropriately.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Research techniques are applied.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Gathering information, reading/viewing, interviewing, observing, using appropriate electronic sources.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Information is evaluated for relevance.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 5

Information is classified, categorized and sorted.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 6

Research findings are analysed and presented in the appropriate format.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 5

Function in a team.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Active participation takes place in group learning situations.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Meetings, site/field visits, excursions, discussions, activities, workshops.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Responsibilities in the team are taken up and group work conventions are applied in learning situations.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Turn taking, rotation of roles: conducting, chairing, recording, reporting.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Conflict management and negotiating techniques are practised in a defined context.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Team work results in meaningful product or outcomes.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Reaching consensus, completed tasks.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 6

Reflect on how characteristics of the workplace and occupational context affect learning.

OUTCOME RANGE

Environmental features, technological resources, communication resources, communication strategies, and multilingual needs in relation to client or colleague interaction.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Sector and organisation type is identified.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Sector/occupational focus: Services, manufacturing, financial, educational, etc.

Organisation type: Government, parastatal, heavy/light industry, large organisation, small business.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Features of the occupational environment are described and discussed.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Ways in which these features affect learning processes and/or application of learning are described and discussed.

UNIT STANDARD ACCREDITATION AND MODERATION OPTIONS

Accreditation Options:

- Providers of learning towards this unit standard will need to meet the accreditation requirements of the relevant ETQA

Moderation Option:

- The moderation requirements of the relevant ETQA must be met in order to award credit to learners for this unit standard.

UNIT STANDARD ESSENTIAL EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE

The essential embedded knowledge will be assessed through assessment of the specific outcomes in terms of assessment criteria.

Learners can understand and explain that language has certain features and conventions, which can be managed for learning purposes. Learners are aware that there are skills, strategies and resources, which will facilitate learning. They are familiar with the workplace context in which their learning will be applied.

Learners are unlikely to achieve all the specific outcomes to the standards described in the assessment criteria without knowledge of the listed embedded knowledge. This means that for the most part, the possession or lack of the knowledge can be directly inferred from the quality of the learner's performance. Where direct assessment of knowledge is required, assessment criteria have been included in the body of the unit standard. The following embedded knowledge should be taken into consideration: the ability to interpret maps, take notes, the ability to read/viewed texts, appropriate communication skills and the location of learning resources.

UNIT STANDARD DEVELOPMENTAL OUTCOME

N/A

UNIT STANDARD LINKAGES

N/A

Critical Cross-field Outcomes (CCFO):**UNIT STANDARD CCFO IDENTIFYING**

Identify and solve problems: using learning programme material and learning tasks to solve problems.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO WORKING

Work effectively with others and in teams: using interactive speech/sign and roles in activities, discussions and projects.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO ORGANISING

Organise and manage oneself and one's activities responsibly and effectively: through organisation of learning materials and evidence.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COLLECTING

Collect, analyse, organise and critically evaluate information: through application of information processing skills in study.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COMMUNICATING

Communicate effectively using visual, mathematical and/or language skills in formal and informal learning situations.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO SCIENCE

Use science and technology effectively and critically: using electronic media for learning.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO DEMONSTRATING

Reflect on and explore a variety of strategies to learn more effectively.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO CONTRIBUTING

Explore education and career opportunities.